

Kanban

A method for visualizing, managing and improving work flow with focus on delivery, WIP and evolutionary improvement.

What is Kanban?

Kanban helps manage and improve workflow by making work and policies visible. A board is useful, but Kanban is more than To Do, Doing and Done columns.

Visualizing flow

Cards represent work items and columns represent flow states. For QA, Ready for QA, Testing and Blocked can reveal queues, blockers and handoffs that were previously hidden.

WIP — Work in Progress

WIP limits restrict how much work is active at once. If Testing has a limit of 3 and already contains three items, the team should help finish or unblock work before pushing more into the queue.

Bottlenecks and blockers

Card accumulation signals investigation. A testing queue may result from unstable environments, batch handoffs, rework, dependencies or limited collaboration — it does not automatically mean “hire more QA”.

Lead Time and Cycle Time

Lead Time measures request-to-delivery time. Cycle Time measures time after work starts according to the team definition. Trends support discussions about predictability and flow.

Kanban and QA

QA can observe item age, blockers, queues, rework and feedback time. The perspective shifts from “how many tests did I run” to “how does quality help work flow and finish”.

Watch out

A nice board does not mean effective Kanban. If WIP is ignored, blockers stay hidden and data is not used to improve flow, visualization alone does not solve the problem.